THE WHOLE STORY · SMALL GROUP GUIDE · LESSON 8 OF 26

The Exodus and the Passover Lamb

Exodus 1–15

> **The big idea:** God heard his people's cry and rescued them from slavery. On the night of judgment, the only thing that mattered was the blood of a lamb on the door. Jesus is our Passover lamb.

Before you meet: Read

Exodus 2:23–3:10 | Exodus 12:1–13 | Exodus 12:21–32 | Exodus 14:10–31 | 1 Corinthians 5:7–8

Open (5 minutes)

Every family has a story it tells again and again. What is one story your family tells, and what does it say about who you are?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"And God heard their _____, and God remembered his _____ with Abraham, with Isaac, and with Jacob." *(Exodus 2:24)*

Pharaoh answered Moses, "Who is the LORD, that I should _____ his voice and let Israel go?" *(Exodus 5:2)*

"Your lamb shall be without _____, a male a year old." *(Exodus 12:5)*

"The blood shall be a _____ for you, on the houses where you are. And when I see the blood, I will _____ you." *(Exodus 12:13)*

"The LORD will _____ for you, and you have only to be _____." *(Exodus 14:14)*

"The LORD is my strength and my _____, and he has become my _____." *(Exodus 15:2)*

Discuss

1. Israel suffered in Egypt for generations. What does Exodus 2:23–25 tell you about God while they waited? *Exodus 2:23–25; 3:7–8*

2. Moses made excuse after excuse until he said, "Oh, my Lord, please send someone else." Which of his excuses sounds most like you? How did God answer him? *Exodus 3:11; 4:10–13*

3. “Let my people go, that they may serve me.” God freed Israel from Pharaoh to serve him. How does that change the way you think about freedom? *Exodus 7:16*

4. Sometimes Pharaoh hardened his own heart, and sometimes the LORD hardened it. How can both be true? Why does it matter that we keep both? *Exodus 8:15; 9:12*

5. The Israelite families were not better than the Egyptians. On Passover night the only question was, is there blood on the door? Why is that good news for people who know they are not good enough? *Exodus 12:13, 23*

6. Israel was saved by standing still and walking through on ground God dried. Where are you trying to save yourself instead of trusting God to fight for you? *Exodus 14:13–14*

Apply this week

Read Exodus 12 slowly, twice. Then imagine someone asks you what Jesus’ death means to you, the way Israel’s children asked about the Passover (12:26–27). Write your answer in two sentences. When you face a sea you cannot cross this week, pray Exodus 14:14.

Memory verse

“For Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed.”

1 Corinthians 5:7

Pray

Thank God that he hears the cry of people in slavery and comes down to rescue them. Name the sin that still enslaves you and ask the Son to set you free. Thank Jesus, the Lamb without blemish, for dying in your place.

LEADER NOTES · LESSON 8

The Exodus and the Passover Lamb

Session plan (about 70 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Exodus 12:1–13 aloud together. Then read 14:21–31.
10 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
30 min	Discuss: choose 4 of the 6 questions. Questions 1, 5, and 6 matter most.
5 min	Walk the group through the Passover and Christ diagram in the full lesson: spotless lamb, blood on the door, no bone broken, judgment passed over.
10 min	Apply and pray. Introduce the memory verse and the reading for Lesson 9 (Exodus 19–20 and 24).

Main points to land

1. God heard, remembered, saw, and knew (Exodus 2:23–25). He came down to rescue his people because of his covenant promise, and the rescue rested on him, not on reluctant Moses.
2. The ten plagues answered Pharaoh's question, "Who is the LORD?" Each one judged a power Egypt trusted, so that Egypt and Israel would know that he alone is God (12:12).
3. Israel was not spared for being better than Egypt. A lamb died in each marked house in place of the firstborn. God passed over because of the blood.
4. Israel did nothing to save themselves at the sea. They stood still and walked through. God does the rescuing, and his people receive it by faith (14:13–14; Hebrews 11:29).
5. Jesus is our Passover lamb (1 Corinthians 5:7). He gave the Lord's Supper at the Passover, and not one of his bones was broken (John 19:36). Only his blood answers for us on the day of judgment.

Core doctrine to teach

Redemption CORE DOCTRINE 8 OF 26

To redeem is to set a slave free by paying a price. God redeemed Israel from Egypt by the blood of the Passover lamb and the power of his arm. That rescue was a picture of a greater one: Christ redeems sinners from sin, death, and the devil by his own blood. *Exodus 6:6; 12:13; Mark 10:45; 1 Peter 1:18–19*

Answer key (Observe)

1. groaning; covenant
2. obey
3. blemish
4. sign; pass over
5. fight; silent
6. song; salvation

Questions people will ask

Is it fair for God to harden Pharaoh's heart and then punish him?
The text says both that Pharaoh hardened his heart (8:15) and that the LORD hardened it (9:12). God put no evil into Pharaoh. He withheld the mercy that would have softened him and gave him over to the hardness he already loved (WCF 5.6). Pharaoh was never forced to sin against his will. Paul faces this same question in Romans 9 and does not explain it away. Admit the mystery, and keep both truths.

How could a good God kill the firstborn, even children?
Do not rush past this. It is a terrible night, and Scripture means it to be. Pharaoh had drowned Israel's baby boys, and God warned him of this plague long before it came (4:22–23). Every house in Egypt and Israel deserved judgment, and Israel's firstborn lived only because a lamb died. Abraham asked, "Shall not the Judge of all the earth do what is just?" We trust that he does, and that he judged sin finally at the cross.

Did the Exodus really happen? I have heard there is no evidence.
The Bible presents it as history, and 1 Kings 6:1 places it 480 years before Solomon began the temple, which works out to about 1446 BC. Ancient Egypt rarely recorded its defeats, and slaves in tents leave little behind for archaeologists. Jesus and the apostles treated the Exodus as real. Point people to the main thing: the Exodus is the pattern God used to show what Christ would do.

Is the Lord's Supper just a way of remembering Jesus?
It is a remembrance, and more. When believers eat and drink in faith, Christ by his Spirit truly feeds their souls with himself and all the benefits of his death (WSC 96; 1 Corinthians 10:16). The bread stays bread. The blessing comes through faith, not through the act itself.

Closing prayer

Father, thank you that you hear the cry of slaves and come down to rescue them. Thank you for the Lamb without blemish, whose blood turns your judgment aside. Bring each of us under that blood. Where we are still slaves to sin, set us free, and give us the song of the redeemed: the LORD is our strength and our song, and he has become our salvation. In Jesus' name, Amen.